Detailed analysis of the component failure during the second attempt led to the refurbishment of the control system. This task was entrusted to a DRDO-ISRO team. The team carried out the rectification of the first stage control system at the Liquid Propel ant System Complex (LPSC) of ISRO and completed the task in record time with tremendous concentration and wil -power. It was nothing short of amazing how hundreds of scientists and staff worked continuously and completed the system readiness with acceptance tests in just 10 days. The aircraft took off from Trivandrum with the rectified control systems and landed close to ITR on the eleventh day. But now it was the turn of hostile weather conditions to impede us. A cyclone threat was looming large. Al the work centres were connected through satel ite communication and HF links. Meteorological data started flowing in at ten-minute intervals.

Final y, the launch was scheduled for 22 May 1989. The previous night, Dr Arunachalam, Gen KN Singh and I were walking together with the Defence Minister KC Pant, who had come to ITR to witness the launch. It was a ful -moon night, it was high tide and the waves crashed and roared,